

Ὀλυμπιόδωρος ὁ Νεώτερος ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεύς

Olympiodorus the Younger on Plato and Aristotle in Alexandria

eul_aid: utq

Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)
Dialect: Κοινή φιλοσοφική [Philosophical Koine](#)
Domain: Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)
Affiliation: [Neoplatonist](#)

Olympiodorus the Younger was a Neoplatonic philosopher who lived and taught in Alexandria during the 6th century CE. He is traditionally considered the last pagan head of the Alexandrian school, continuing to teach after the closure of the Athenian Academy in 529. His career represents the persistence of pagan philosophical education within a Christian empire.

He was a student of Ammonius Hermiae and taught classes attended by both pagan and Christian students. His surviving works are primarily commentaries based on his lectures. These include explanations of Plato's dialogues **Alcibiades I**, **Gorgias**, and **Phaedo**, as well as commentaries on Aristotle's **Categories** and **Meteorologica**. A work titled **Life of Plato** is also attributed to him.

According to modern scholars, his approach often focused on the ethical and logical teachings of Plato and Aristotle, avoiding more contentious metaphysical debates. This conciliatory style is seen as a practical adaptation to his historical context. Olympiodorus is a significant transitional figure in late antique philosophy. Academics view him as the final representative of the Alexandrian commentary tradition, which sought to harmonize the works of Plato and Aristotle.

His writings are valuable for understanding the teaching methods of his time and for preserving earlier Neoplatonic ideas. By transmitting this philosophical heritage, his work helped ensure its survival into the Byzantine and medieval periods.

Works (7)

- Σχόλια εἰς τὰ μετεωρολογικὰ Ἀριστοτέλους · [Commentary-Aristotle in Greek](#) · 338 passages
- Σχόλια εἰς τὸν Ἀλκιβιάδην Πλάτωνος · [Commentary-Plato's Alcibiades](#) · 235 passages
- Σχόλια εἰς τὸν Γοργίαν Πλάτωνος · [Commentary-Plato's Gorgias](#) · 463 passages
- Σχόλια εἰς τὸν Φαῖδωνα Πλάτωνος · [Commentary-Plato's Phaedo](#) · 159 passages
- Προλεγόμενα · [Introduction](#) · 25 passages
- Σχόλια εἰς τὰς κατηγορίας · [On the Categories, Commentary](#) · 123 passages
- Σχόλια εἰς τὸ περὶ ἑρμηνείας Ἀριστοτέλους · [Scholia-Aristotle's Book-Interpretation](#) · 16 passages

Other Neoplatonist Authors

- [Ἀμελίου Ἐπιστολή · Amelius Letters](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀμμώνιος ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · Ammonius of Alexandria Phil](#) · 5 works
- [Δαμάσκιος ὁ Δαμασκηνός · Damascius of Damascus](#) · 7 works
- [Δαβίδ ὁ Ἀνίκητος · David the Invincible](#) · 2 works
- [Δέξιππος ὁ Νεοπλατωνικός · Dexippus the Neoplatonist](#) · 1 work
- [Ἠλίας ὁ Νεοπλατωνικός · Elias the Neoplatonist](#) · 3 works
- [Εὐσέβιος ὁ Μύνδιος · Eusebius of Myndus](#) · 1 work
- [Ἱεροκλῆς ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · Hierocles of Alexandria](#) · 1 work
- [Ἰάμβλιχος ὁ Ἀνώνυμος · Iamblichus Anonymous](#) · 1 work
- [Ἰάμβλιχος ὁ Χαλκιδεὺς · Iamblichus of Chalcis](#) · 6 works
- [Ἰάμβλιχος ὁ Χαλκιδεὺς · Iamblichus of Chalcis II](#) · 1 work
- [Ἰουλιανὸς ὁ Ἀποστάτης · Julian the Apostate](#) · 20 works